

Client Case Study: Brightline Retail Group

Retail & Consumer Goods | Portland, OR

The Challenge

Brightline Retail Group (client ID CL-1027) operates 118 specialty home-goods stores across the Pacific Northwest and Mountain West. Following two consecutive quarters of margin compression, Brightline's VP of Operations, Janelle Ruiz, engaged CRCG in March 2023 to assess supply chain resilience, and subsequently extended the relationship into a store-level replenishment forecasting pilot.

Our Approach

Engagement 1: Supply Chain Resilience Assessment (PRJ-2318, March–August 2023)

CRCG mapped Brightline's supplier base down to tier-2 where data permitted, identifying that 34% of SKU volume by revenue depended on a single overseas manufacturing cluster vulnerable to port congestion. The team ran four disruption scenarios and recommended a dual-sourcing strategy for the highest-risk SKU families, along with revised safety stock buffers.

Engagement 2: Store Replenishment Forecasting Pilot (PRJ-2412, April 2024–January 2025)

Building on the resilience assessment, Brightline engaged CRCG's Digital & Analytics practice, led by Lead Data Strategist Hana Brennan-Cole, to pilot a machine-learning-based store-level replenishment forecasting model across 22 pilot stores, aiming to reduce both stockouts and excess inventory carrying costs. The pilot encountered a notable setback in mid-2024 when initial model versions overfit to pilot-store seasonality (see Risk Register entry RSK-005), requiring the team to add cross-validation against non-pilot store clusters before the model was deemed production-ready.

Results

Metric	Before	After	Notes
Single-source SKU revenue exposure	34%	19%	18-month dual-sourcing transition plan
Pilot store stockout rate	8.9%	5.1%	22 pilot stores, trailing 90 days
Pilot store excess inventory (days of supply)	47 days	33 days	22 pilot stores, trailing 90 days
Forecasting pilot program cost	\$525,000 (budget)	\$561,900 (actual)	Cost overrun attributable to extended model validation cycle

“The supply chain work gave us the map. The forecasting pilot gave us the engine. Together they changed how our planning team thinks about risk, not just how they react to it.”

— Janelle Ruiz, VP Operations, Brightline Retail Group